

Marry Me White Bean Soup with Kale

This creamy, flavor-packed white bean and kale soup, inspired by Marry Me Chicken, comes together quickly for a cozy weeknight meal. Sun-dried tomatoes plus the oil from the jar infuse the base with rich, savory depth, while fresh basil and Parmesan cheese add a bright and satisfying finish.

By **Amanda Holstein** | Published on January 15, 2026

✔ Reviewed by Dietitian **Emily Lachtrupp, M.S., RD**

Active Time: 35 mins

Total Time: 35 mins

Servings: 4

Nutrition Profile:

No Added Sugar Gut Healthy Anti-Inflammatory Mediterranean Diet Sesame-Free Anti-Inflammatory Weight Loss Nut-Free Healthy Pregnancy Healthy Aging Healthy Immunity Soy-Free High-Fiber Vegetarian High-Protein Egg-Free Gluten-Free Low-Calorie

Ingredients

- 2 tablespoons oil from sun-dried tomatoes jar
- 1 medium yellow onion, finely chopped (about 1½ cups)
- ½ cup drained julienne-cut sun-dried tomatoes in oil, divided
- 3 cloves garlic, minced (about 1 tablespoon)
- 1½ teaspoons no-salt-added Italian seasoning blend
- ½ teaspoon crushed red pepper
- ¼ teaspoon salt
- 1 large bunch curly kale (about 8 ounces), stemmed and chopped (about 8 cups)
- 5 cups lower-sodium vegetable broth
- 1 (15-ounce) can no-salt-added white beans, rinsed (about 1½ cups)
- ¼ cup chopped fresh basil, plus more for garnish
- ⅓ cup heavy cream
- 3 ounces reduced-fat cream cheese, at room temperature (about ⅓ cup)
- ½ cup grated Parmesan cheese (2 ounces), divided

Directions

Step 1

Heat 2 tablespoons sun-dried tomato oil in a large Dutch oven over medium heat. Add chopped onion; cook, stirring occasionally, until softened, about 5 minutes. Stir in ¼ cup sun-dried tomatoes, the minced garlic, 1½ teaspoons Italian seasoning, ½ teaspoon crushed red pepper and ¼ teaspoon salt. Cook, stirring constantly, until the mixture is fragrant and the tomatoes have darkened slightly, about 2 minutes. Stir in chopped kale; cook, stirring constantly, until just wilted, about 2 minutes.

Step 2

Add 5 cups broth, the rinsed beans and ¼ cup basil; bring to a boil over medium heat. Reduce heat to maintain a lively simmer; cook, uncovered, stirring occasionally, until the kale is tender, about 15 minutes. Remove from heat.

Step 3

Stir in ⅓ cup cream, 3 ounces cream cheese and ⅓ cup Parmesan. Whisk until the cream cheese is melted and the mixture is fully combined.

Step 4

Divide among 4 bowls. Top each with 1 tablespoon Parmesan. Garnish with additional basil, if desired.

To make ahead

Refrigerate in an airtight container for up to 4 days or freeze for up to 2 months.

Frequently Asked Questions

Can I use any kind of kale?

We selected curly kale for this recipe; it's commonly available at most grocery stores, but you can substitute another type if you like. Regardless of the type of kale you choose, be sure to remove any tough parts that might be difficult to chew, such as the ribs found in the center of the leaves.

Can I make my own vegetable broth?

Absolutely! You might want to try our Super-Simple Vegetable Broth recipe, which yields 12 cups—more than you'll need for this recipe, but you can freeze whatever you don't use. Pour the extra broth into ice cube trays, silicone molds or, if you're short on freezer space, use zip-top bags. The broth should last three to six months in the freezer.

What's the best way to store and reheat leftovers?

Let the soup cool, add to an airtight container and then pop it in the fridge for up to three days. Slowly reheat it on the stovetop over medium heat, or use a microwave, heating in 1-minute intervals until it reaches the desired temperature.

Can I freeze the soup?



You can, and that's a good reason for double-batching it. Allow it to cool completely, transfer it to a freezer-safe container or a bag for compact storing, and freeze it for up to three months. When ready to enjoy, thaw it overnight in the refrigerator, then gently reheat it on the stovetop or in the microwave.

What should I serve with Marry Me White Bean Soup with Kale?



Add another level of comfort by pairing this soup with a hot sandwich like our Grilled Cheese with Spinach & Tomato Sandwich, Rotisserie Chicken Salad Melt or Open-Face Cauliflower-Cheddar Melts. It would also be great with our Tuna Salad & Tomato Sandwich, Pickled Beet, Arugula & Herbed Goat Cheese Sandwich or Banh Mi with Crispy Tofu.

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Nutrition Facts

Per serving: **Serving Size about 1 $\frac{3}{4}$ cups** 409 calories; total fat 25g; saturated fat 10g; cholesterol 48mg; sodium 702mg; total carbohydrate 35g; dietary fiber 8g; total sugars 5g; added sugars 0g; protein 16g; vitamin c 59mg; calcium 316mg; iron 4mg; potassium 1040mg

Additional reporting by Carrie Myers, M.S. and Linda Frahm

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